

Dianyuan Zou

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Research Interests

Representation Learning; Learning and Reasoning in Neural Networks; Active Perception and Embodied Intelligence; Computer Vision

Education

University of California, Berkeley, Extension Aug 2026–May 2027
Visiting Student, Berkeley Global Access Program Berkeley, CA

Huazhong University of Science and Technology Sep 2023–Jun 2027
B.Eng. Candidate in Electronic Information and Communications, Advanced Mathematics and Physics Track Wuhan, China
GPA: 4.58/5.00 Average: 91.5/100

Publications and Preprints (*: equal contribution)

1. Manni Cui*, Ruiqi Liu*, **Dianyuan Zou***, et al.
GlobalForge: Towards Robust AI-Generated Image Detection
Preprint, arXiv:2607.14684
2. Manni Cui*, Ziheng Qin*, ZiAn Wang, Ruiqi Liu, **Dianyuan Zou**, et al.
Rethinking the Readout: Unlocking Video Backbones for AI-Generated Video Detection
Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2026

Research Experience

Westlake University, ENCODE Lab Jun 2026–Present
Visiting Research Intern, advised by Prof. Huan Wang Hangzhou, China

- **Ongoing project:** Investigating whether a vision model learns better representations when it is given the freedom to actively decide where to look next, rather than being fed a fixed set of crops.
- Implemented the training framework (DINO-style self-distillation on a block-causal Vision Transformer with an acquisition head), and am evaluating the learned representations on ImageNet with k-NN, linear, and MLP probes.

AI-Generated Image and Video Detection Apr 2026–Aug 2026
Research Contributor, HUST Wuhan, China

- Collaborated with project partners and UCAS researchers to evaluate methods for detecting AI-generated images and videos.
- Implemented and evaluated new detection methods, and helped write the manuscripts and create figures. The work led to two papers: *Rethinking the Readout* (NeurIPS 2026) and *GlobalForge* (preprint, co-first author).

RoboMaster Global Robotics Competition – Vision System 2023–2025
Algorithm Member, Langya Algorithm Group, HUST Wuhan, China

- Developed and tuned a real-time auto-aiming computer-vision pipeline in C++ for competition deployment; the team won Second Prizes in the 2025 RoboMaster Series Competitions.
- Collected training data, trained and quantized a YOLO11-s model, and deployed it on an Intel NUC using OpenVINO to accelerate inference.

Honors and Awards

National Scholarship	2024, 2025, 2026
Ministry of Education of China; awarded to about 0.3% of college students each year	
Outstanding Student Scholarship	2024, 2025, 2026
Huazhong University of Science and Technology	
First Prize, Datang Cup National Final Communication Competition	2025
Ranked third nationally	
Second Prizes, RoboMaster Series Competitions	2025
Second Prize, Embedded Systems Design Competition	2025
Silver Medal, Chinese Mathematical Olympiad (CMO)	2023
National final of China's high-school mathematics olympiad	

Skills

Programming: C, C++, Python, LaTeX.

Machine Learning and Vision: PyTorch, OpenCV.

Systems and Robotics: Embedded systems, ROS2.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese; English (IELTS 7.0).